ZZ-R-001207(GSA-FSS)
March 29, 1972

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

RUBBER STAMP, FIXED TYPE, PRE-INKED

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers pre-inked rubber hand stamps with fixed legends.

1.2 Classification. Rubber stamps covered by this specification shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - Desk or counter stamp.
Type II - Pencil cap stamp.
Type III - Key chain stamp.
Type IV - Pocket stamp.
Type V - Special machine use.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-Up.
PPP-F-320 - Fiberboard, Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade), and Cut Shapes.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191/GEN (General Provisions) - Textile Test Methods.
Fed. Test Method 191/5660 - Colorfastness to Light of Textile Materials, Accelerated Method.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specification procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 7520

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Tariff Publishing Officer, Room 202 Union Station, 516 W. Jackson Blvd., Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Bid samples. Two bid samples of each type and color offered shall be submitted with each bid and shall be examined for the following:

Life test (4.1.1).	Examination for operational performance (4.3.3).
Fading test (4.1.1).	Suitability of material used.
Visual examination of end-item (4.3.1).	General appearance and workmanship.

3.2 Material. The manufacturer is given wide latitude in his selection of materials and process of manufacture provided the product meets the requirements of this specification. The stamps shall be ink-containing, impregnated rubber or plastic material. The ink shall be of a permanent type.

3.3 Design and construction. The type I stamp shall be constructed in such a manner that the ink-containing material (including printing surface) does not rest on the desk or counter top when in an upright position and not in use. The printing surface of the type II, III, and IV stamps shall be covered when not in use. The type III stamp shall have a means of attachment to a key chain.

3.3.1 Ink color. Stamps shall be pre-inked with the color or multi-colors specified in the contract or order (see 6.2).

3.3.2 Legend. The contents (wording), number of lines, whether lines are to be blocked or centered, size and style of type, border requirements, and special characters or design shall be as specified (see 6.2). A replica of the legend shall be fixed to the type I, and the position of the replica shall indicate correct position for use.

3.4 Performance

3.4.1 Ink. The ink shall not penetrate a good grade of white bond paper to such an extent that it would stain an object in contact with the side opposite the stamped side (see 4.3.3). The ink shall produce a dense impression and dry by absorption, oxidation or evaporation within 5 seconds to prevent offset, blurring or smearing. The ink shall not bleed from the rubber or plastic material when installed in any oriented position. (See 4.1.1.)

3.4.2 Quality and number of impressions. The stamps shall produce clear, distinct, sharp single impressions of equal intensity, with no closing of the characters. A minimum of 25,000 uniform impressions shall be obtainable. The stamps shall not require blotting or prestamping on a scratch pad to activate the ink for initial or subsequent use. There shall be no separation of components and the impressions shall show only a slight degree of fading when exposed to the radiation from a carbon arc lamp for 48 hours. (see 4.1.1.)

3.5 Marking for identification. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, the contractor shall permanently indent his name or trademark of such known character easily identifiable with said manufacturer, on each of the types I, II, III and IV stamps.

3.6 Sets. When specified (see 6.2), the type I stamp shall be assembled in sets. The number of stamps required and their legends (see 3.3.2) shall be as specified (see 6.2). A suitable tray shall be furnished with each set.

3.7 Workmanship. The stamps shall be clean, free from sharp edges, burrs, and splinters and color(s) shall be uniform throughout each area in which used. Legend replica shall be legible. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the acceptable quality level specified.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Established material, process of manufacture, and formula testing. Prior to the first shipment under the contract, the supplier shall conduct the following established material, process of manufacture, and formula testing. Retesting shall be conducted in the event of any changes in these procedures during the contract period.

Life test: A life test shall be conducted for each type and color offered to determine compliance with the 25,000 impression requirement of 3.4.2. The test shall be conducted on a suitable machine. Pressure exerted on the stamp to produce impressions shall be adjusted to produce acceptable imprints, with a maximum adjustment to six pounds and a minimum dwell time of 1 second and maximum of 3 seconds. Test duration shall be 1,000 continuous impressions followed by a 30 minute rest period, repeated until 25,000 impressions are obtained. Examine all impressions for compliance with 3.4.

Fading: Three impressions shall be made on each of two sheets of a good grade of white bond paper. One sheet on which the impressions have been made shall be exposed to the radiation from a glass-enclosed carbon arc lamp for 48 hours in accordance with method 5660 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191. The other sheet on which impressions have been made shall be retained but not exposed. The exposed sample shall show not more than a slight degree of fading when compared with the unexposed sample (see 3.4.2).

4.1.2 Report of established material, process of manufacture, and formula testing. The supplier shall maintain records of established material, process of manufacture, and formula testing. These records shall be available to the authorized Government representative, and shall include (1) name and address of the laboratory which conducted the test, (2) name of test and date, and (3) test data (results).

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. A lot shall consist of all the stamps presented for inspection at one time as defined in MIL-STD-105.

4.2.2 Sampling of end-item for visual defects. A random sample of stamps shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level I. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one stamp.

4.2.3 Sampling for preparation for delivery requirements. For examination of interior packages the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, and selected at random just prior to the closing operation. Closure defects shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level I. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.4 Sampling of end-item for operational performance test. A random sample of stamps shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2. The AQL shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one stamp.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual examination of end-item. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table I.

TABLE I. Examination for visual defects

Examine	Defects
Design and construction (3.3)	Design or construction not suitable for purpose intended.
Ink color (3.3.1)	Not pre-inked with ink color or multi-colors specified.
Legend (3.3.2)	Legend not as specified.
	Replica of legend missing or not as specified.
Marking for identification (3.5)	Missing, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Sharp edges.
	Burrs.
	Color(s) not uniform.
	Legend replica not legible.

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4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II.

TABLE II. Defects in preparation for delivery

Examine	Defects
Marking (interior and exterior container)	Omitted or incompleted. Incorrect or illegible. Improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Material	Any component missing, damaged or otherwise defective. Any component not as specified.
Packaging	Improper method of closure. Box not compact or well filled.
Packing	Improper method of closure.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of liner, containers, flaps, strapping, or taping. Bulging, distorted, or damaged container.
Content	Number per container as more or less than required.

4.3.3 Examination for operational performance. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be subjected to the following operational performance test:

Twenty-five impressions shall be made on a good grade of white bond paper. The paper on which the impressions are to be made shall be backed up with a second sheet of paper and both sheets shall be on a smooth hard surface. After obtaining the 25 impressions, placed the stamp in an upright position for 2 hours. Without blotting or prestamping on a scratch pad, make an additional 25 impressions. Any nonconformance with the requirements of 3.4 shall consistute failure of the test.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Twelve stamps shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, variety I, style III, IV, or VIII, type G or I, class 1; PPP-B-665, class 1, style C, D, or G; or PPP-B-676, type I, variety 1, class A, style 2 or 3. The box shall be closed in accordance with the applicable box specification to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2 Level B. Twelve stamps shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676. The box shall be closed in accordance with the applicable box specification to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.3 Level C. The stamps shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturer's standard practice, providing that this insures protection for the stamps during shipment and provides for safe delivery to their destination. When fiberboard is utilized, it shall conform to PPP-F-320.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Stamps in quantities as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. The weight of the contents of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Unless otherwise specified, three hundred and sixty stamps, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall conform to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant.

5.2.3 Level C. Stamps, packaged as specified in 5.1.3, shall be packed in containers that will assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification rules and the National Motor Freight Classification rules. When fiberboard is utilized, it shall conform to PPP-F-320.

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5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Type I, II, III and IV stamps covered by this specification are intended for general office use. Type V stamps are intended for special application where the stamps are placed in a machine to produce fixed impressions.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type of stamp required (see 1.2).
(c) Color or multi-colors of ink required (see 3.3.1).
(d) Legend requirements (see 3.3.2).
(e) When sets are required, number of stamps and their legends (see 3.6).
(f) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(g) Quantity for level A packing, when applicable (see 5.2.1).
(h) Specify when shipping containers shall conform to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, for level B packing (see 5.2.2).
(i) Marking requirements (see 5.3).

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GENERAL SERVICES ADMINISTRATION - FEDERAL SUPPLY SERVICE

SPECIFICATION COMMENT SHEET

BUDGET BUREAU NO. 29-R0175

INSTRUCTIONS

This form provides a way for users of this specification to inform the originator of problems encountered in its use. It is not to be used to request changes to accommodate proprietary features. All comments will be considered and appreciated, but please do not expect a reply. To comment: detach, complete, and mail to: General Services Administration, FSS (FMSO), Washington, DC 20406

NOTE: Comments on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any part of the document or serve to amend contractual requirements.

1. SPECIFICATION

ZZ-R-001207 (GSA-FSS) - RUBBER STAMP, FIXED TYPE, PRE-INKED

2. CONTRACT NO. *(If any)*	3. QUANTITY ON CONTRACT *(Optional)*	4. DOLLAR VALUE *(Optional)*

5. GENERAL NATURE OF PROBLEM *(e.g., inspection difficulties, manufacturers unable to meet tolerances, containers collapse under normal warehousing conditions, etc.)*

6. SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS AFFECTED *(include paragraph number and lines of wording)*

7. SPECIFIC PROBLEMS *(e.g. tests in 4.2.2 will not assure that the battery will last required time; temperature ranges in table 2 do not conform to commercially available items.)*

8. RECOMMENDATIONS

9. NAME OF MANUFACTURER, ASSOCIATION, GOVT., AGENCY, ETC.	10. ADDRESS *(Number, Street, City, State and Zip Code)*

11. NAME AND TITLE OF SUBMITTER	12. DATE

FORM GSA FEB 69 2200

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